

Nathanael Sheehan

PhD Student

Curriculum Vitae

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About

I am a philosopher and sociologist of science working in the chair of Philosophy and History of Science and Technology at the Technical University Munich. My core research areas include: the philosophy of (open) data, the sociology of (scientific) standards, and environmental intelligence. I draw on mixed methods such as quantitative modelling, ethnographic observations and semi structured interviews in order to understand the historical, philosophical, social and technical dimensions

Education

2014-2018	BSc Computer Science (1st) Manchester, UK	Manchester Metropolitan University
2019-2020	Master of Smart Cities and Urban Analytics (Distinction) London, UK	University College London
2021-2025	PhD Environmental Intelligence Exeter, UK	Exeter University

Work Experience

2017-2019	Software Engineer London, UK	RetalMeNot
2020	Research Assistant Remote	University College London
2021	Geographical Information System Engineer Remote	Bristol City Council
2021	Research Engineer Remote	Oxford University
2021-2022	Research Fellow Remote	Leeds University
2024	Research Assistant Exeter, UK	Exeter University
2025	Post-Doctoral Researcher Munich, Germany	Technical University Munich

Research Publications

- Talbot, J., Lucas-Smith, M., Speakman, A., Streb, M., Nuttall, S., Carlino, D., Johansson, P., Sheehan, N., Groot, N., & Lovelace, R. (2022). Active Travel Oriented Development: Assessing the suitability of sites for new homes. *European Journal of Transport and Infrastructure Research*, 22(4), 51–72. <https://doi.org/10.18757/ejtir.2022.22.4.6015>
- Sheehan, N., Botta, F. and Leonelli, S. (2024) Unrestricted Versus Regulated Open Data Governance: A Bibliometric Comparison of SARS-CoV-2 Nucleotide Sequence Databases. *Data Science Journal*, 23: 29, pp. 1–29. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.5334/dsj2024-029>
- Sheehan, N., & Leonelli, S. (2025). Reconciling data actionability and accountability in global health research: The case of SARS-CoV-2. *Global Public Health*, 20(1). <https://doi.org/10.1080/17441692.2024.2436422>
- Chatikobo, T., Griffiths, F., Hayden, N., Leeming, G., Mishra, A., Morris, E., Schirru, L., Sheehan, N., Williams, A. & Sekalala, S. (2026). Open Science, Health Data and Epistemic Harms: A Multidisciplinary Reflection. *Data Science Journal*, 25(1), 15-15. <https://doi.org/10.5334/dsj-2026-015>
- Sheehan, N. (2026). The Sequence and the Standard: An Account of Participatory Informational Format Exclusion (PIFE). *Social Epistemology*, 1–13. <https://doi.org/10.1080/02691728.2026.2682153>

Research Software

- Joseph Talbot, M. L.-S., Nathanael Sheehan. (2021). ActDev.
- Robin Lovelace, L. H., & Sheehan, N. (2021). Pct: Propensity to cycle tool.
- Sheehan, N. (2022). Thames21 socio-ecological data.
- Sheehan, N. (2022). Dimaqdata: Data integration model for air quality data.
- Sheehan, N., Lovelace, R., Nederlof, T., & Carlino, D. (2022). Abstr: R interface to the a/b street transport system simulation software.
- Sheehan, N (2022). IndoorRSSI: Indoor Received Signal Strength Indicator
- Sheehan, N (2023). eaCatcheR: The eaCatcheR R package provides an interface to data from the environment.data.gov.uk catchment planner.
- Sheehan, N (2023). Gigwork Stories: Doing Gig Work, a research project which studies the management, solidarity and resistance of platform food couriers in Manchester (UK), Cluj-Napoca (Romania) and Lyon (France).
- Sheehan, N (2023). RENA: The rena package provides tools for bulk downloading read/analysis files from ENA via FTP using the ena-ftp-downloader.
- Sheehan, N (2024). C2A: contains the code and data used to produce the results presented in the paper “Unrestricted versus Regulated Open Data Governance: A Bibliometric Comparison of SARS-CoV-2 Nucleotide Sequence Databases”.
- Alcalay, R. B., Sheehan, N., & Trappes, R. (2025). conceptcartography (Version 1.0.0) [Computer software]. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.1234>
- Sheehan, N (2026). Pianeta Lab - Storie di Insetti: Multi-modal stories of insects.

Research Presentations

2020	Digital Ecologies, Online Performing digital water publics: a computational approach
2021	Decarbon8, Online Working with origin-destination and activity data to model decarbonisation
2021	Intelligent Machines, Emotions, and Our Planet, Online Linking Sentiment with River Health in the Thames Basin
2021	Modelling World, Online The ActDev Project
2022	Data Crunch, Online Open Data in the Private Industry
2022	Philosophy of Open Science open meeting, Online Responsible Repositories
2022	PhillinBioMed conference, Pittsburgh Analysis of COVID-19 sequencing platforms
2023	Research Data Alliance, Gothenburg Analysis of COVID-19 sequencing platforms
2023	Institute for Data Science and AI, Exeter Analysis of COVID-19 sequencing platforms
2023	PHIL_OS Exploratory Conference, Exeter Open Data and Software in Science
2023	International Society for the History, Philosophy and Social Studies of biology, Toronto Covid-19 Genomic Data: Diverse Enough?
2024	Understanding Life in a Changing Planet, Exeter Between Open and Closed Data: A metascientific study on global health data practices
2024	Philosophy of Science Association, New Orleans Participatory Informational Format Exclusion
2025	European Bioinformatics Institute, Hinxton A journey from data ethics to AI governance
2025	International Society for the History, Philosophy and Social Studies of biology, Porto Data Brokers in Broken Data Communities
2026	Research Data Alliance 26th Plenary The Ethical Data Initiative
2026	Society for Philosophy of Science in Practice, Cambridge A Philosophy of Data Formats